Q+A

EARS TO THE GROUND

*Artist duo **Jiten Thukral and Sumir Tagra**, who unveiled 'Arboretum' this art season, on their work, technology and what keeps them together*

Q. What was most memorable for you in the recently concluded Art Fair?
The meaningful conversations and ideas exchanged were the highlights. The Art Fair was in a fortnight when so much was happening in the city, and we were glad to host our exhibition around a time when numerous curators and art aficionados were visiting.

Q. Why an artist as a gardener in an arboretum, and not an artist as an explorer in a jungle wilderness?
Much as we wander, our explorations involve the discipline of waking up and reaching the studio. This injects us with hope in what we build, a determination to nurture ideas. It's all with an optimism that someday, they may bear fruit!

Q. You have been working together for 20 years. How do you surprise each other?
The idea of working together is a commitment to building together, to values to be unlearned and evolved, to ideas only some of which may take form. We try to stay like a child within...

Q. Where do you keep returning to (other than your studio) for creative rejuvenation?
We mostly travel to see art, and to visit studios that are pushing boundaries.

Q. What's your ritual for disconnecting from technology?
We spend a lot of our lives in the studio, manoeuvring around different materials, navigating and experiencing each day as handmade and machine-made.

Q. You've painted, sculpted, directed video and made interactive games. Which medium calms you the most?
"Breathe with each leaf you paint" is an idea that animates us. We use this technique to paint and meditate, to keep us aligned when change is all around.

with Bhaskar Kowshik



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